

Kristijan Garic

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Network analysis (discourse network analysis, temporal networks), policy learning, advocacy coalition framework, policy subsystems, belief systems, Bayesian statistics.

EDUCATION

2023 - present	PhD Government at University of Essex .	
2020 - 2021	MSc Public Opinion and Political Behaviour at University of Essex .	<i>Distinction</i>
2016 - 2020	Bachelor's Degree in Political Science at University of Zagreb .	<i>Cum laude</i>

WORK EXPERIENCE

Suvey Data Linkage Officer – Understanding Society Jan 2022 - present

- Data processing (cleaning and quality checks).
- Preparing data documentation (user guides).
- Educating users how to use the UK Household Longitudinal Study data.
- Collaborating with other team members on various projects.

Research Asistant – ESRC Business and Local Government Data Research Centre Apr 2021 - May 2021

- Cleaned and prepared dataset provided by client.
- Collected additional data from other sources.
- Applied appropriate quantitative models: OLS, truncated model, time series.
- Wrote the policy evaluation report of the service provided by the client.

Research Assistant – SOIH, European Social Fund Feb 2021 – Mar 2021

- Designed and ensured the functionality of the survey for the Croatian Union of Associations of Persons with Disabilities (SOIH) and the European Social Foundation (PI: Daniela Sirinic).
- Collected and cleaned the data.
- Conducted a descriptive analysis using SPSS.

Research Assistant – Croatian Government and European Social Fund Mar 2018 – Apr 2020

- Conducted both telephone and in-person interviews, transcribing them using NVIVO software.
- Organized and coordinated research teams.
- Contributed to the publication of the analysis of the project, “Scalpel or Axe? - Environmental Impact Assessment analysis in Croatia.”

PUBLICATIONS

Leifeld, P., and Garic, K. (2026). **Measuring Frame Evolution: Smoothed Temporal Framing Trajectories in Complex Policy Debates.** *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*. 64: 1688–1714. [link](#)

Garic, K., and Leifeld, P. (2025). **A three-stage model of the maturation of nascent policy subsystems toward stable advocacy coalitions, with evidence from the UK's response to COVID-19.** *Policy Studies Journal*. 54(1): e70047. [link](#)

Vandenhoe, K., Garic, K., and Leifeld, P. (2025). **When does discursive change happen? Detecting phase transitions in discourse networks of sustainability transitions.** *Energy Research & Social Science* 122: 104020. [link](#)

REFeree FOR JOURNALS

Political Research Exchange.

Policy Studies Journal.

TEACHING

**Introduction to Geographical Data Linkage –
Linking Open Data to the UK Household Longitudinal Study** Jul 2023 - present
Workshop instructor.

AI-Enhanced Research Design Jul 2025
Teaching Assistant - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis.

Geospatial Data and Spatial Analysis Jul 2025
Teaching Assistant - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis.

Machine Learning for Social Scientists Jul 2024
Teaching Assistant - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis.

Quantitative Text Analysis Jul 2023
Teaching Assistant - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis.

**Introduction to Understanding Society
using Stata / R / SPSS or SAS** Nov 2022 - Nov 2023
Workshop instructor.

TRAINING

- Geospatial Data and Spatial Analysis - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Essex, 2025.
- AI-Enhanced Research Design - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Essex, 2025.
- Agent-Based Models - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Essex, 2024.
- Machine Learning for Social Scientists - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Essex, 2024.
- Introduction to Quantitative Text Analysis - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Essex, 2023.
- Introduction to Network Science - IADS, Essex, 2023.
- Moving Beyond Descriptives: Basic Hypothesis Testing with R/Statnet - EUSN, London, 2022.
- Introduction to Network Analysis tools in R - EUSN, London, 2022.
- Introduction to Applied Bayesian Statistics - Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, Essex, 2021.

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

SENA 2024 Winter Workshop, University of Essex, Colchester, UK 13/03/2024

Presented paper: “Measuring Frame Evolution: Ideal Types of Temporal Framing Trajectories in Complex Policy Debates.” Kristijan Garic, Philip Leifeld.

European Social Networks Conference (EUSN) 2023, Ljubljana, Slovenia 06/09/2023

Presented paper: “Application of Stage Dynamic Detection for Detecting Community Changes in Temporal Networks.”
Kristijan Garic, Philip Leifeld, and Kimberley Vandenhoe.

European Social Networks Conference (EUSN) 2022, London, UK 15/09/2022

Presented poster: “A Three-Stage Model of the Maturation of Nascent Policy Subsystems towards Stable Advocacy Coalitions, with Evidence from the UK’s Response to Covid-19.”

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Department of Government, University of Essex Oct 2024 - present

PGR representative.

ISER seminar series Sep 2023 - present

Organiser.

SOFTWARE

Stata R programming (contributor to rDNA package.)

SPSS NVIVO

LaTeX MS Office

Git Github

Linux NetLogo

Ruby Jekyll

AWARDS AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Award for the Best Conference Paper at the 14th International Sustainability Transitions Conference for **“Improving Discursive Approaches to Sustainability Transition Studies: Elaborating Discourse Network Analysis”**, Utrecht, September 2023.
- **Accredited Researcher** – Office for National Statistics, February 2023.
- **“Introduction to Applied Bayesian Statistics”** - Scholarship for Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis, academic year 2020/2021.
- **BIG Essex Award for voluntary activities**, University of Essex, academic year 2020/2021.
- **Dean award for a team project**, University of Zagreb, academic year 2019/2020.
- **Dean award for academic excellence**, University of Zagreb, academic year 2018/2019.

REFERENCES

References are available upon request.

Last updated: September 19, 2026